

Email & Hosting for PS Rao

Options, costs and the migration plan off BigRock — October 2026

Prepared for PS Rao Corporate Solutions Pvt. Ltd. · All prices in ₹, excluding 18% GST unless stated · Costing is shown for 5 mailboxes (info@, career@ + 3 staff); multiply per user for more.

Summary. The new website is already live on Cloudflare Pages at **psrao-consulting.pages.dev** at **₹0/month**. The only thing the BigRock VPS still does is host email. Moving email to a proper mail provider lets the VPS (expires **6 Nov 2026**) lapse, taking the recurring hosting bill from **≈₹10,000–15,000/year** to **₹0** for the website, and email to between **₹0** and **₹8,200/year** depending on the option chosen below.

1. Where the money goes today vs. after

Item	Today (BigRock)	₹ / year	After migration	₹ / year
Website hosting	VPS Linux KVM (shared with email)	≈10,000–15,000	Cloudflare Pages + Functions + KV + R2	0
Admin panel / CMS	Custom panel on the VPS	included above	Built-in /admin on Cloudflare (KV + R2)	0
Chatbot / AI in admin	—	—	Cloudflare Workers AI (free tier, 10k neurons/day)	0
Email (5 mailboxes)	cPanel webmail on the VPS	included above	Option A / B / C — see §2	0 – 8,200
Domain psraoassociates.com	BigRock — renew by 17 Oct 2026 (auto-renew OFF)	≈1,000–1,300	Keep at BigRock (or transfer to Cloudflare Registrar at cost price)	≈1,000–1,300
Domain psrao.co.in	Current registrar	≈700–900	Same; DNS moves to Cloudflare (free)	≈700–900
SSL certificate	Let's Encrypt / cPanel	0	Cloudflare (automatic)	0
Total recurring		≈12,000–17,000		≈1,700 – 10,400

BigRock VPS figure is the typical renewal band for the Linux KVM plan; check the exact renewal quote in the BigRock panel. Wallet balance today: ₹35.82.

2. Email: Open-source vs Zoho Mail vs Google Workspace

Three realistic ways to run **@psrao.co.in** mailboxes once the VPS is gone. Staff are comfortable with Gmail, so each option is also rated on "feels like Gmail".

A · Open-source

₹0 – 12,000/yr

₹0 routing · **₹8–12k** self-

hosted

- **A1 Cloudflare Email Routing + Gmail "Send mail as"** — forward info@/career@ to existing Gmail accounts and reply from the @psrao.co.in address. ₹0.
- **A2 Self-hosted (Mailcow / Mail-in-a-Box / Zimbra)** — your own mail server on a VPS. Server ₹8–12k/yr **plus** someone to maintain it.

B · Zoho Mail

₹0 – 4,500/yr

₹0 · ₹59/user/mo

- **Free:** 5 users, 5 GB each, web + mobile app only (no IMAP/Outlook), one domain.
- **Mail Lite** ₹59/user/mo (5 GB) or ₹75 (10 GB): IMAP, Outlook, multiple domains. 5 users = **₹3,540/yr**.
- **Mail Premium** ₹199/user/mo: 50 GB, archival, e-discovery.

C · Google Workspace

₹8,200/yr

₹137/user/mo

- **Business Starter** (India, annual plan): 30 GB per user, Gmail, Meet (100), Drive, Docs/Sheets, shared calendars.
- 5 users = **₹8,220/yr** + GST (≈₹9,700). Monthly-flexible plan costs more; promos of ~₹350/mo often apply to the flexible plan.
- **Starter+ / Standard** (2 TB, recording) ₹736/user/mo.

Side-by-side

	A1 · Routing + Gmail send-as	A2 · Self-hosted open-source	B · Zoho Mail Lite	C · Google Workspace Starter
Cost / year (5 users)	₹0	₹8,000–12,000 + admin time	₹3,540 (₹4,500 for 10 GB)	₹8,220 (+GST ≈ ₹9,700)
Storage per user	Your personal Gmail's 15 GB	Whatever the VPS disk allows	5 GB / 10 GB	30 GB (pooled)
Feels like Gmail	Yes — it is Gmail	No (Roundcube/SOGoo webmail)	Similar; clean, fast	Yes
Outlook / phone app (IMAP)	Via Gmail	Yes	Yes (not on the Free plan)	Yes
Deliverability (mail not landing in spam)	Gmail's reputation	Your IP's reputation — the #1 problem with self-hosting	Excellent	Excellent

Calendar, Drive, Meet	Personal Google account (not company-owned)	Partial (Zimbra has calendar)	Zoho Calendar; Workplace ₹99 adds Docs/WorkDrive	Full suite, company-owned
Admin control (reset staff passwords, offboard)	None — mail sits in personal accounts	Full, if you know Linux	Yes, admin console	Yes, admin console
Backups, uptime, security patches	Google	You	Zoho	Google
Data location	Google global	Your VPS (India)	Zoho India (Mumbai/Chennai)	Google (India region available)
Migration of old cPanel mail	Manual (IMAP copy per user)	IMAP sync (imapsync)	Built-in migration tool	Built-in migration tool
Setup effort	1 hour	2–3 days + ongoing	2–3 hours	2–3 hours
Verdict	Fine stopgap; weak for a firm (no ownership)	Not recommended — costs more than Zoho once time is counted	Best value	Best experience if budget allows

Recommendation. If ₹8–10k/year is acceptable, **Google Workspace Business Starter** — the team already works in Gmail and the firm owns the accounts. If the budget must stay minimal, **Zoho Mail Lite (₹3,540/yr)** gives real company mailboxes with Outlook/phone support. **Zoho Free (₹0)** works as a bridge for the 5 mailboxes while deciding. Self-hosting is the only option we advise against: the server costs as much as Zoho Lite before counting maintenance, and spam-filter reputation is a constant battle.

3. Cloudflare Pages as the replacement for the BigRock VPS

The VPS was a single Linux server doing everything. Cloudflare splits that into managed services, each on a free tier that this site's traffic will not exceed.

What the VPS did	Cloudflare equivalent	Free-tier limit	Cost	Status
Serve the website (Apache/Nginx)	Pages — global CDN, automatic SSL, HTTP/3	Unlimited bandwidth, 500 deploys/month	₹0	Live

Backend API (Node on the VPS)	Pages Functions (serverless)	100,000 requests/day	₹0	Live — events, chat, careers, CMS
Database (MySQL)	Workers KV	1 GB, 100k reads/day, 1k writes/day	₹0	Live — all site content
File uploads (images, résumés)	R2 object storage	10 GB, 10M reads/month	₹0	Live — 120 images, résumé store
Admin panel	Built-in /admin with AI drafting	Workers AI 10,000 neurons/day (≈100 generations)	₹0	Live
DNS (BigRock nameservers)	Cloudflare DNS	Unlimited	₹0	Pending — step M3
Email forwarding	Email Routing (forward only, no mailboxes)	Unlimited	₹0	Optional
Mailboxes (cPanel)	Not offered — use \$2	—	see \$2	Pending — step M2
SSH, cron, backups, patching	Not needed — no server to maintain	—	₹0	—

If the site ever outgrows the free tiers, the next step is the Workers Paid plan at US\$5/month (≈₹420) — still well under the VPS. R2 required a card on file to enable; it is already enabled on the account and bills ₹0 within the free quota.

What is already running on Cloudflare (₹0/month)

- Website with all client feedback from June applied — Pvt. Ltd name, career@/info@ emails, Events & Due Dates calendar, AI chatbot.
- CMS at **/admin**: hero, services, team, insights, events, jobs, client logos, case studies, testimonials — with AI drafting and résumé screening.
- Careers application flow with private résumé storage.
- SEO: every page pre-rendered, sitemap, structured data; Lighthouse desktop 86–90.

4. Migration plan, costed

Order matters: renew the domain first, move email second, move DNS third, cancel the VPS last. Nothing on the live site is interrupted at any step.

#	Activity	Who	When	Effort	One-time ₹	Recurring ₹/yr
M0	Renew psraoassociates.com at BigRock (auto-renew is OFF; wallet ₹35.82 — pay by card). Confirm registrar and expiry of psrao.co.in.	KV Sir	Before 17 Oct	10 min	0	≈1,000–1,300
M1	Choose the email option (\$2) and confirm the 5 mailbox addresses. Tell us where info@/career@ are hosted today (we believe cPanel on the VPS).	KV Sir	This week	15 min	0	0 – 8,220

M2	Create mailboxes on Zoho/Google; migrate old mail from cPanel with the provider's IMAP migration tool; set up phones/Outlook. Old and new run in parallel.	Us + each staff member	Week 1	2–3 h + 10 min per person	0	—
M3	Move DNS to Cloudflare : add psrao.co.in to the Cloudflare account, copy existing records, switch nameservers at the registrar. Add MX, SPF, DKIM, DMARC for the new mail host. Attach psrao.co.in to the Pages site (replaces pages.dev URL).	Us	Week 1–2	1–2 h; DNS settles in ≤24 h	0	0
M4	Redirect psraoassociates.com → psrao.co.in (301, via Cloudflare) so old links and Google results keep working. Wire application-alert emails to career@.	Us	Week 2	30 min	0	0
M5	Verify : send/receive from every mailbox, test from Gmail/Outlook, confirm no mail lands in spam (SPF/DKIM pass), site resolves on psrao.co.in with SSL.	Us + KV Sir	Week 2	1 h	0	0
M6	Two-week overlap , then export anything still on the VPS (cPanel full backup, old DB) to a drive as an archive.	Us	Weeks 2–4	1 h	0	0
M7	Let the VPS lapse on 6 Nov 2026 (do not renew). Also ignore the SiteLock→cWatch notice — not needed on Cloudflare.	KV Sir	6 Nov	0	0	saves 10,000–15,000
Total migration cost					₹0	₹1,700 – 10,400 / yr (vs ≈12,000–17,000 today)

Two dates that cannot slip. 17 Oct 2026 — psraoassociates.com renewal (if it lapses, the old address, old email and Google rankings for it are lost). **6 Nov 2026** — VPS expiry; email must be migrated (M2) and verified (M5) before this, or inbound mail to info@/career@ stops.

Decision needed from you

Question	Options	Our suggestion
Email provider	A1 ₹0 · B Zoho Lite ₹3,540/yr · C Google ₹8,220/yr	C if budget allows, else B
Primary website domain	psrao.co.in · psraoassociates.com	psrao.co.in (matches email), redirect the other
Domain registrar	Keep BigRock · Move to Cloudflare Registrar (cost price, no mark-up)	Keep for now; move at next renewal

Prices: Zoho Mail India price list (Oct 2026): Free ₹0, Lite ₹59/₹75, Premium ₹199, Workplace Standard ₹99 per user/month. Google Workspace India: Business Starter ₹137/user/month on annual commitment; flexible plan higher. Cloudflare free-tier limits from developers.cloudflare.com. BigRock VPS figure is the typical renewal band; confirm in the BigRock panel. All figures exclude GST unless stated.